

INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE

LT03

Unit 3 Elements of crime and mystery

Mark scheme

January 2026

Version: 1.0 Final

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

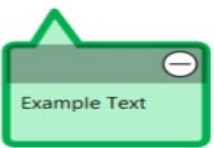
Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 7–9. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Incorrect		Toolbar Tooltip: Incorrect		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text – text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 18 years old so we are judging their skills at the end of Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	• Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	• Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. • Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	• Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	• Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. • Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Macbeth*

‘In *Macbeth*, Shakespeare presents murder as just as likely to be committed in a place of apparent safety as in a place of danger.’

To what extent do you agree?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Macbeth* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Duncan who is murdered in a chamber in a castle of a family he trusts, rather than on the battlefield he has just left
- Lady Macduff and her children who are murdered at home in their castle in Fife
- the grooms who guard Duncan’s chamber who are murdered by Macbeth while at their post
- Banquo who is killed on an isolated pathway at nighttime while attempting to escape the danger at Macbeth’s castle
- Macbeth and Young Seward who are both murdered on the battlefield
- Cawdor who is executed for treason at a battle camp.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the dramatic irony present in Duncan’s description of the castle as ‘a pleasant seat’ which ‘recommends itself’ to him
- Banquo’s description of Duncan’s ‘unusual pleasure’ at the Macbeths’ hospitality and his repetition of Duncan calling Lady Macbeth ‘most kind hostess’
- Macbeth’s soliloquy where he reflects on Duncan being in his home ‘in double trust’ and states that ‘he should against his murderer shut the door’
- the repeated reference to ‘torches’ in the stage directions and ‘light’ in the script to emphasise the darkness of the pathway where Banquo is murdered
- the messenger’s fearful warnings to Lady Macduff to ‘be not found here’
- the dramatic inclusion of soldiers ‘bearing colours’ and drummers and trumpeters in the scenes surrounding Macbeth’s death
- Duncan’s formal pronouncing of Cawdor’s execution and Malcolm’s reportage style recount of how it took place.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	2
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Samuel Taylor Coleridge: *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*

‘The killing of the albatross is presented as a crime that lacks any clear motive.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the religious value based on the albatross who has ‘a Christian Soul’
- the albatross being traditionally a symbol of good luck to sailors – the ice breaks after the albatross appears
- the mariners being initially angry with the Mariner, suggesting the crime is incomprehensible
- the Mariner who seemingly regrets his actions and calls the shooting a ‘hellish thing’
- the mariners say it was ‘right’ after the mist moves on, saying the bird ‘brought the fog and mist’
- students may engage with the idea of ‘clear’ motive and might consider transgression itself as a motive as with the journey.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Coleridge’s choice not to include the Mariner’s thinking at the point of shooting but to focus instead on the mariners’ reaction
- the Christian iconography and imagery associated with the albatross
- the negative repetition in Part 2, stanza 2 where ‘no sweet bird did follow’
- the use of the mariners’ dialogue to show their dismay: ‘Ah wretch! said they’, and later their approval
- the tone of the Mariner’s narrative which is remorseful.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0 3

Robert Browning: *Selected Poems*

‘The criminals in these poems are presented as feeling proud rather than ashamed of the crimes they have committed.’

To what extent do you agree? In your answer, refer to ‘Porphyria’s Lover’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Browning’s *Selected Poems* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the lover who expresses pride in his actions and seems to believe he has granted Porphyria’s ‘darling one wish’, so is not ashamed of murdering her
- the Duke who states that he took action because he chooses ‘never to stoop’ implying his actions are commendable
- the speaker in ‘The Laboratory’ who is excited to enact her crimes and does not wish to ‘spare’ her victim ‘the pain’ of death
- the Mayor who shamelessly refuses to pay the piper
- the speaker in ‘The Confessional’ who was filled with shame for both taking a lover and for inadvertently betraying him
- the patriot who acknowledges his ‘year’s misdeeds’
- the townsfolk who try to offer the Piper ‘silver and gold’ if he will return the children which perhaps implies acknowledgement of their guilt.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of dramatic monologues from the perspectives of criminals to give access to their psyche
- the symbolism of Porphyria’s head on the lover’s shoulder, which suggests pride in his achievement of murdering her
- the explicit revealing of the details of Porphyria’s murder which suggests pride rather than shame
- the ending moral in ‘The Pied Piper of Hamelin’ and the narrative which repeats the story painted on the great church window which seems to imply moral growth
- the symbolic removal of the mask in ‘The Laboratory’ so that the narrator is not prevented from seeing the death ‘close’
- the ending of ‘My Last Duchess’ which focuses on the dowry negotiations for the Duke’s next bride
- the speaker’s exclamation of ‘shame avaunt!’ in ‘The Confessional’ which acts in contrast to the title itself.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	4
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Charles Dickens: *Oliver Twist*

‘In *Oliver Twist*, the deaths of characters are always presented as being the consequence of crime.’

To what extent do you agree?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Oliver Twist* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Fagin’s execution as a legal punishment for his crimes
- Fagin’s reason for ‘why the sentence of death should not be passed upon him’ being that he is ‘an old man’
- Sikes’ accidental death while he is escaping the vengeful mob
- Sikes who has a vision of Nancy’s death before he loses his balance and hangs himself
- Nancy’s death – a gruesome murder after she tried to do the right thing by both Oliver and Sikes
- Little Dick, Oliver’s mother and the pauper’s wife who die as a consequence of social crimes and poverty
- Bullseye who dies out of misplaced loyalty to Sikes.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the physical descriptions of Fagin receiving his sentence: ‘haggard’, ‘like a marble figure’, ‘gazed stupidly’ etc
- the focalised narrative of Fagin’s last night alive where he considers ‘all of the men he had known who died upon the scaffold – some of them through his own means’
- the realistic setting of Newgate for Fagin’s last night and public execution
- the symbolic value of Sikes’ death through hanging which implies execution and punishment
- the chapter title for the chapter containing Nancy’s death: ‘Fatal Consequences’
- Nancy’s pitiful pleas to save her life which call upon Christian ideas of repentance
- the emotive language used to describe the deaths of Little Dick, Oliver’s mother and the pauper’s wife and the intrusive and satirical narration which criticises the circumstances that lead to these deaths.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	5
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Edgar Allan Poe: *Collected Stories*

‘In these stories, the detective figures are presented as highly skilled and effective.’

To what extent do you agree? In your answer, make reference to ‘The Purloined Letter’ and at least one other story.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Poe’s *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Dupin in ‘The Purloined Letter’ and ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ who is exceptional and who solves the crimes that the Parisian police cannot
- the complexity and puzzle of the ‘ourang-outang’ and the sailor
- Dupin’s playing of the same trick on the minister as he himself played on the young lady
- the police in ‘The Tell-Tale Heart’ who are convinced by the narrator’s manner and only catch the criminal due to his panicked confession
- the police in ‘The Black Cat’ who are thorough but are also assisted by the cat’s cry in finding the body
- the narrator in ‘The Man of the Crowd’ who admits failure at the end.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the epigraphs for ‘The Purloined Letter’ and ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ which both focus on skill and cunning
- the analogy of the ‘even or odd’ game to describe Dupin’s skill in ‘The Purloined Letter’
- the opening of ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ which is an extended discussion of analytical skill and prefaces the introduction of Dupin’s ‘peculiar analytical ability’
- the contrast between Dupin and the narrator whose inability to comprehend Dupin’s deductions serves to emphasise his genius
- the contrast between Dupin and the Parisian police
- the narration in ‘The Tell-Tale Heart’ which reveals that ‘in the enthusiasm of [his] confidence’, it was he who brought the police into the scene of the crime
- the first-person narrator in ‘The Man of the Crowd’ who is exquisitely attentive to all small details.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	6
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Robert Louis Stevenson: *Collected Stories*

‘In these stories, the rich are presented as having the power to avoid being harmed by criminal activity.’

To what extent do you agree? In your answer, make reference to at least two stories.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Stevenson’s *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Mcfarlane’s offer to ‘do something’ for Fettes which implies buying his continued silence
- Mr K- who escaped prosecution despite his involvement in the Burke and Hare murders
- Jekyll who is unable to control Hyde’s influence over him and whose wealth offers no protection from the danger Hyde presents to him
- Danvers Carew who is brutally murdered despite his wealth
- the lengthy conversation between Brisetout and Villon where he discusses how it is poverty that makes him a thief
- candidates may consider criminal activity that has been done to or done by the wealthy.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the detailed description of Macfarlane’s clothes which reveals his wealth and success
- the abbreviation of Mr K- which protects his identity despite others being executed for providing him with bodies
- the contextual reference to the Burke and Hare murders which compares Mr K-’s lack of prosecution to Burke’s execution
- Jekyll’s first-person account of his first instantaneous change where he contrasts his life as Jekyll: ‘wealthy, beloved, the cloth laying before me in the dining room’, with his life as Hyde: ‘hunted, houseless’
- the items listed as being found on Carew’s person: ‘a gold watch, a purse’ both of which indicate his wealth
- the repeated and explicit contrasts between Villon and Brisetout’s financial circumstances and the sociological debate they enter into
- the ending of ‘A Lodging for the Night’ where Villon reflects on his theft of Brisetout’s goblets.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 7

Agatha Christie: *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd*

Explore the significance of King's Abbot and Fernly Park as settings for crime in *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd*.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the peaceful countryside setting of King's Abbot which Poirot has chosen as a place for his retirement where he can 'grow marrows'
- the normality of the village which Dr Sheppard describes as 'very much like any other' which allows Christie to make the murder particularly shocking
- King's Abbot being home to wealthy and upper middle-class characters such as 'unmarried ladies and retired military officers' meaning there is a propensity for 'gossip'
- the village setting which allows Christie to create comedy through poking fun at stereotypical residents because 'in King's Abbot we permit people to indulge their little idiosyncrasies'
- Fernly Park which is a large and important house and means that Ackroyd appears very much like a 'country squire'
- Fernly Park and specifically Ackroyd's study within it which allow Christie to make use of the 'locked room murder' and 'closed circle of suspects' tropes.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the contrast between the peaceful countryside setting and the crime and corruption that exists within the community
- the solving of the crime which re-establishes social order at the end of the text
- the use of precise time and location settings to establish alibis of the suspects
- the inclusion of the illustrations of Fernly Park and Ackroyd's study which allow the reader to act as detective
- Fernly Park as a symbol of Ackroyd's wealth and social standing within King's Abbot
- the precise descriptive detail used to describe Fernly Park which allows Christie to leave clues for the reader.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 8

Qiu Xiaolong: *Death of a Red Heroine*

‘Despite her celebrity, Guan Hongying is presented as an exploited figure who is isolated from other people.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Death of a Red Heroine* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- her celebrity which can be seen in the newspaper clippings and propaganda about her: ‘her noble spirit in serving the people’ etc
- Chen and Yu’s reaction to her identification and their understanding of ‘the need to hush up the sensational details’ of her murder
- her washing and eating privileges and the luxury of her room to herself
- her neighbour’s views of her as ‘a celebrity’ who ‘would not mix with us’
- her lonely and tiny room with its ‘hardboard bed’
- her sexual exploitation at Wu’s hands and her murder.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the title which focuses on her celebrity
- her role as model worker which is described religiously as ‘a hallowed image’
- the insults from her neighbours: ‘cold ass’
- the repeated metaphor of Guan’s ‘mask’
- the details of the two sides of Guan’s wardrobe: one half ‘conservative’ and professional and the other half with ‘romantic’ and ‘erotic’ underwear which reflects the two sides to her character
- the transcript of the interview between Yu and Lai where he describes their relationship
- the climactic discovery of Wu’s photographs of her.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 9

Kate Atkinson: *When Will There Be Good News?*

Louise says ‘Men like Decker were inadequates.’

To what extent do you agree that in *When Will There Be Good News?*, Atkinson’s male criminals are all presented as weak and inadequate individuals?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *When Will There Be Good News?* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Decker and Needler who are loners and failures, described by Louise as ‘inadequates’
- Neil who is cowardly and doesn’t ‘try hard enough’ to get his wife and baby back from danger
- Ginger and Blondie, and Billy who are small-time thugs and their bullying of Reggie who is initially defenceless
- Peter and John who are overpowered by Joanna despite outnumbering her
- the shadowy threat of Anderson who is described as powerful and relentless: ‘once he gets his teeth into something he doesn’t let go’
- Jackson who does commit crimes so could potentially be viewed by candidates as a criminal, but who does so for reasons presented as admirable.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Louise’s focalisation where she ruminates on ‘men like Decker’ and contrasts them with the heroics of the women they attacked for whom she would ‘give a medal’
- the contrast between Neil and Reggie’s reaction to Joanna’s kidnapping
- the imagery used to emphasise Reggie’s defencelessness: ‘a small wounded animal’, which in turn presents Ginger and Blondie as bullies
- the simplistic language used to describe Joanna’s killing of Peter and John which implies it was straightforward to overpower them
- the ambiguity surrounding Anderson which has the effect of making him seem more elusive and frightening
- Jackson’s ‘crimes’ which are seen through Reggie’s approving perspective.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.